

Marketing Fundamentals

Part of **Digital Marketing Essentials** · Estimated time: 30 min

Introduction

Most marketing activity can be mapped onto a funnel: a large number of people become aware of a product, a smaller number consider it seriously, and a smaller number still actually decide to buy.

Core ideas

- Awareness stage: people encounter your brand for the first time — social posts, search ads, and word of mouth typically live here.
- Consideration stage: people are comparing options — content like comparison guides, reviews, and case studies matters most here.
- Decision stage: people are ready to act — clear pricing, testimonials, and a low-friction checkout matter most here.
- Not every channel needs to do every job: a search ad usually targets people already close to a decision, while a broad social campaign often targets pure awareness.

Try it yourself

Pick a product you've bought recently. Write down one specific piece of marketing (an ad, a post, a review) that influenced you at each stage of the funnel — awareness, consideration, decision.

Further reading

- [HubSpot — What Is a Marketing Funnel?](https://blog.hubspot.com/marketing/marketing-funnel)

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- [Google Digital Garage — Fundamentals of Digital Marketing](https://learndigital.withgoogle.com/digitalgarage)

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